



Noise launches Buds Prima 2

Featuring 50 hours of playtime, these budget friendly babies should last long enough.
<https://digit.in/sep22-07>



Startup disappears from market

Bolt Mobility, a tech startup co-founded by Usain Bolt, is inoperational in at least 5 US cities.
<https://digit.in/sep22-08>

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FEATURE

The UPI Journey



Where did it come from, and where's it headed?

Satvik Pandey | satvik@digit.in

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nified Payments Interface (UPI), one of the most popular payment platforms in the country, has

seen a monumental rise in popularity since its introduction in the year 2016. UPI, as a platform, was meant to facilitate the adoption of online payments in India by providing consumers and retailers a universally accepted platform that would be accessible through different service providers. As of August 2, 2022, over six billion UPI transactions have been recorded,

with projections of the UPI transactions crossing a billion transactions a day mark in the next five years.

Unified Payments Interface or UPI is a landmark concept that originated in India. The testament to its success is that it is being adopted not only in India but overseas as well. Earlier this year, it was announced that UPI services would start in France soon too. While the details of the service launch aren't crystal clear yet, efforts are actively being put in to ensure everything goes according to the law of the land while preserving the easy-to-use philosophy that lies at the core of UPI.

The EU debut of UPI drove up the number of countries where UPI works from five to six. Other nations that have adopted UPI are Bhutan, Nepal, Malaysia, Singapore, and United Arab Emirates.

Not only this, in December 2019, Google took note of the success

of UPI and recommended the US also set up a real-time UPI-esque payments system. FedNow, which was the payments system developed after this recommendation, finds its roots in UPI.

There are other iterations of the payments interface. For example, there is UPI 123PAY, which utilised voice activation and UPI 2.0, which was launched in 2018, enabling consumers to link their overdraft accounts with UPI.

During the peak of the pandemic, UPI hit record usage numbers and became the quintessential payment method. As the restrictions lifted and people started stepping out and carrying out their day-to-day activities, the numbers rose even higher. The ripple effects of this can be seen in the transactions recorded in July this year. As per the data released by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), in July, there were 6.28